# RUNNING RED

*An Armoured Truck Heist*

A standalone custom episode for 7TV Second Edition.

## SYNOPSIS

The shipment is moving. An armoured truck is running a fixed route across town — surface streets, a couple of turns, one set of lights it can't avoid. The crew has a narrow window to hit it before it reaches the depot. The truck's skeleton crew won't be enough to stop a determined crew, but they don't need to be — they just need to hold on long enough for the cavalry to arrive.

## PROLOGUE

### SET UP

- **The Route.** Place five Route Markers (R1–R5) in a rough line from one playing area edge to the opposite edge, following roads if your terrain has them. R1 is the Armoured Truck's start point; R5 is its destination. R3, the midpoint marker, is the Signal.
- **The Truck.** Use the Truck or Van vehicle profile (Central Casting, Extras & Vehicles) reskinned as the Armoured Truck. It does not cost ratings and is not purchased from the Escort's cast budget — like a VIP Extra, it is scenario dressing, not a combatant bought from anyone's points. It is crewed by two Security Guard Extras, who are part of the cast and paid for normally out of the Escort's ratings. Set the Truck up in base contact with R1.
- **Cast Start Locations.** The Escort is the defending cast; the Robbers are the attacking cast. The defending player chooses which playing area edge holds R1. This may also serve as their Act Two reinforcement edge, or they may nominate a different edge for that purpose (see The Cavalry, below). The attacking player separately chooses their own board edge, representing where their crew staged the ambush, and may deploy anywhere within the half of the playing area closest to it — not the standard 3″ deployment strip. Any Vehicle in the Robbers' cast must instead be set up at their chosen edge.
- **The Escort's Backup.** Only the Truck, its two crew, and the ratings spent on them come on board at the start. The remainder of the defending cast's ratings are held in reserve until called in — see Going Loud and The Cavalry, below.

## THE SCENE

### AND… ACTION!

Determine initiative as normal.

### SPECIAL RULES

- **The Truck Runs the Route.** During each of its activations, the Truck must use at least one action to move toward the next Route Marker in sequence. It cannot skip markers and cannot voluntarily reverse direction. If nothing prevents it, it will eventually reach R5 and exit the board.

- **The Signal.** When the Truck's activation would bring it into base contact with R3, roll 1D6 before it moves: on a 1–3, the light's red and the Truck may not move this activation (its crew may still act normally); on a 4–6, it's green and the Truck proceeds as normal. A Star or Co-Star in base contact with R3 may instead take a special action to override the crossing signal, forcing it red without a roll.
- **Stopping the Truck.** The Truck's movement ends immediately for the turn if a strike against it or its crew inflicts the Immobilised status — ramming or sustained gunfire forcing it off the road. The Block special effect alone does not stop an armoured vehicle; something has to actually hit it.
- **Going Loud.** The first time the Armoured Truck or either of its crew is the target of a successful strike, the Escort's backup goes on alert. From that point on, the Truck is freed from the Route — its controlling player may move it at full speed, hold it stationary, or manoeuvre it as they see fit each activation. Reaching R5 remains its objective, but it is no longer bound to advance marker by marker to get there. Starting with the Escort's next activation, reinforcements may be called in piecemeal rather than waiting for Act Two: each time the Escort activates a reinforcement model for the first time, it enters from R1, and its first action that activation must be a move action bringing it onto the playing area from that edge.
- **The Cavalry.** If the Truck and its crew reach the first script card of Act Two without ever having been struck, Going Loud is never triggered. Instead, the Escort's full reinforcement force is placed together at their chosen board edge (nominated during Set Up) using the standard cast start location rules, and activates normally from that point on.
- **Breaching the Cargo.** Once the Truck is stationary (whether from the Signal or from being stopped), an attacking model in base contact may take a special action and pass a Body statistic test to force the cargo doors. On a success, place three loot tokens in base contact with the Truck. These are collected and carried off the board like standard objective tokens.

## DIRECTOR'S CUT

Add one of these for variety:

- **Inside Man** — One attacking Extra may be set up using the Espionage special effect rules, representing a mole already riding with the Truck's crew.
- **Convoy** — The Escort's reinforcements include a Squad Car alongside their Extras.
- **No Loose Ends** — The Escort gains +2 VP if every attacking Extra is removed from play by game's end.
- **Held at Gunpoint** — Instead of removing a crew Extra from play as normal, the attacking player may choose to inflict the Captured status on them if reduced to 0 Health while an attacker is in base contact. A Captured crew member takes no further actions and cannot be Breached-for as a target, but stays in play — reinforcing the "hands where I can see them" heist beat instead of a firefight with security guards. If both crew Extras are removed from play or Captured, an attacker in base contact may Breach the cargo automatically — no Body test required. No one's left to fight for the vault.

## EPILOGUE

### VICTORY POINTS

Use the standard victory point rules. In addition:

- Attackers gain +1 VP for each loot token carried off the board via the Robbers' chosen start edge or the edge directly opposite it. Loot tokens do not score if they leave the board any other way.

- Defenders gain +2 VP if the Armoured Truck exits the board at R5 with at least one loot token still aboard — and the episode ends immediately when this happens.
- Defenders gain +1 VP if the Truck is never Immobilised for the entire game.

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## PRODUCTION NOTES

**Ratings.** No fixed total is set here. Prime Directives ran at 30 ratings per side — a similar total works well, with the Truck's two Security Guards eating roughly 8–10 of the Escort's points and the rest held as reinforcements.